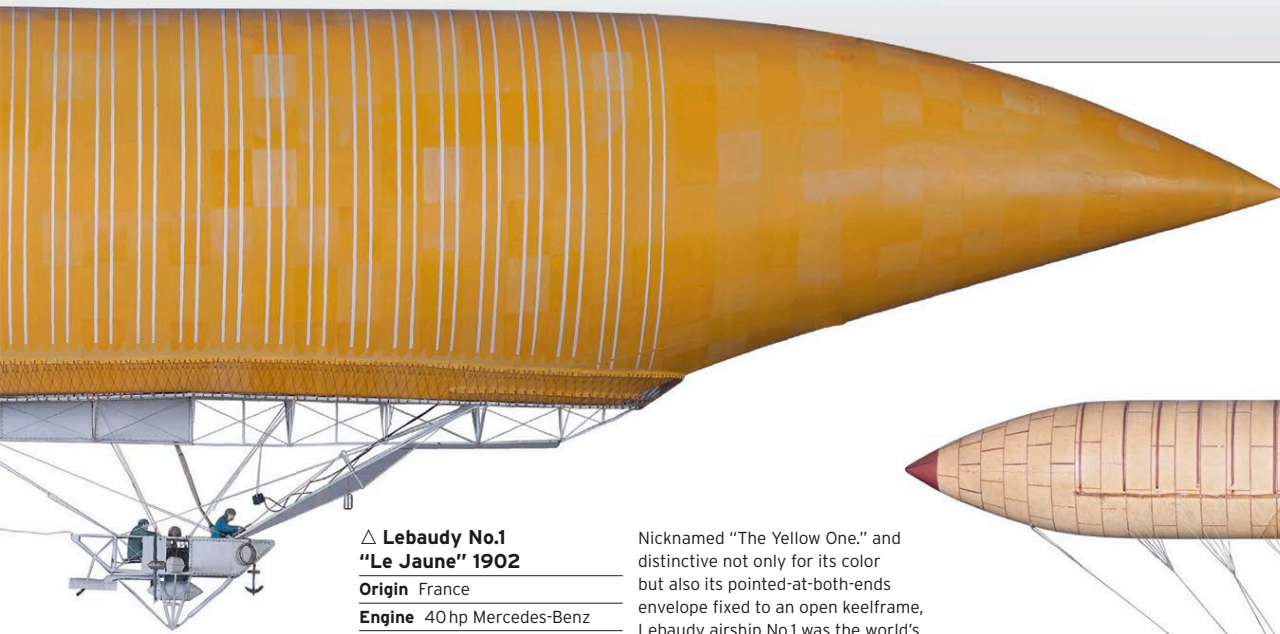




△ Lebaudy No.1 "Le Jaune" 1902

Origin France

Engine 40 hp Mercedes-Benz

Top speed N/A

Nicknamed "The Yellow One," and distinctive not only for its color but also its pointed-at-both-ends envelope fixed to an open keelframe, Lebaudy airship No.1 was the world's first successful airship.

▷ Severo Airship Pax 1902

Origin France

Engine 24 hp Buchet driving tractor screw, 16 hp Buchet driving pusher screw

Top speed N/A

As well as propulsion screws, the Pax had lifting screws to control trim. Sadly, during its trials over Paris, it caught fire and exploded, killing its creator-pilot and his mechanic.



▽ Santos Dumont No.1 1898

Origin France

Engine De Dion Bouton

Top speed N/A

Wealthy Brazilian Alberto Santos Dumont arrived in Paris in 1897 and began experiments with balloons and airships. His airship No.1 ended its first flight in a tree.



△ HMA No.1 1909

Origin UK

Engine 2 x 160 hp Wolseley

Top speed N/A

His Majesty's Airship No.1, built for the Royal Navy, was named "Mayfly"—but unfortunately it did not: a gust broke its back on the ground before its first test flight.



△ Clément-Bayard Airship Adjutant Vincenot 1911

Origin France

Engine 2 x 120 hp Clément-Bayard

Top speed N/A

The Adjutant Vincenot was 289 ft (88 m) long and had a boxkite-type tail. A month before the outbreak of WWI, on June 28, 1914, it made a record endurance flight lasting 35 hours 19 minutes.



△ Chalais-Meudon Type T Airship 1916

Origin France

Engine 2 x 150 hp Salmson

Top speed 50 mph (80 km/h)

Built at the military engineering establishment and army balloon school of the same name in southwestern Paris, the Chalais-Meudon series of nonrigid airships were used in WWI for antisubmarine patrols.



△ Submarine Scout Zero Airship 1916

Origin UK

Engine 75 hp Rolls-Royce

Top speed N/A

Conceived by the Royal Naval Air Service as an inexpensive weapon against the urgent threat of German submarines, the SS "blimps" (nonrigids) proved very successful, and 158 were built.



◁ Zeppelin LZ 96 1917

Origin Germany

Engine 5 x 240 hp Maybach

Top speed 66 mph (106 km/h)

Wearing the serial L49, Zeppelin LZ 96—a typical large German rigid airship—flew two North Sea reconnaissance missions and one bombing raid on England before it was captured in France.